

Shuhan Zhang

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Interactive Media graduate combining programming and interaction design with participant studies, documented experiments and critical design to create and evaluate interactive systems.

EDUCATION

University of York

Sept 2023 - Jun 2026

BSc (Hons) Interactive Media

Upper Second Class Honours (2:1). Relevant coursework: User Experience Design, Mobile Interaction, Speculative Design, AI and Its Application to Creative Practice.

RESEARCH & DESIGN PROJECTS

Revive - Lighting in a 2.5D Pixel Game

Final-year dissertation | 2025-2026

- Built a 2.5D pixel environment in Unreal Engine 5 (Lumen/Blueprints) and ran a nine-participant, within-subjects study comparing Day, Sunset and Night, using a 3x3 Latin square under University of York ethics approval.
- Used descriptive analysis of gameplay logs and ratings: Night had the longest mean completion time and most backtracks; all nine participants rated it hardest, while five selected it as most immersive.

AI-Assisted Browser Game Experiment

Individual academic project

- Developed six versions from a hand-coded baseline to Gemini 3 Pro Thinking outputs, maintaining logs of prompts, outputs and manual fixes. Analysed v1-v5; v6 added scenes and music outside the analysis.
- In a separate six-map experiment, observed input rewriting on an all-wall map; a revised prompt preserved the map in the documented retest. Manually repaired a wall-spawn bug in v3.

MiniQuest - Gamifying the Break from Routine

Mobile Interaction project

- Designed and built a native Android prototype in Kotlin, combining quests, RPG rewards and movement sensing to explore alternatives to repetitive routines.
- Implemented offline-first MVVM with Room and Kotlin coroutines, plus accelerometer-based step detection without a dedicated step-counter sensor.

Cogni-Stream - Speculative BCI Critical Design

Speculative Design project

- Developed the concept, interaction design and HTML/CSS/JavaScript website for EnGram+, a fictional brain-computer-interface subscription service.
- Translated van Dijk's digital divide and Suarez-Villa's technocapitalism into tiered knowledge access, downgrade penalties and a visible status marker, making unequal access and corporate dependency part of the interaction.

THRESHOLD - Tangible AI Identity Exploration

Solo prototype | In development

- Developing an Arduino Nano ESP32 hardware loop and Python decay engine. Drawing on Locke and Parfit, designed a conversation flow with six declining indicators to question perceived AI identity; physical integration and user testing remain pending.

INDUSTRY EXPERIENCE

Shanghai Sanyi Culture Communication Co.

Jun - Sep 2025

Art & Interaction Design Intern, QQ Xuanwu Project Team

- Reviewed 80+ fashion and prop UI icons weekly for file-naming and formatting compliance before asset integration, as part of the design team.
- Designed 4+ high-fidelity UI pages weekly in Figma and mapped navigation flows to support the team's interaction design discussions.

SKILLS

Methods: within-subjects studies, descriptive analysis, gameplay observation, speculative and critical design

Engines & Tools: Unreal Engine 5 (Lumen, Blueprints), Unity, Figma, Maya, Arduino

Programming: Kotlin, JavaScript, HTML/CSS, C#, Python